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New Zealand vs England, 2021

New Zealand keep doing this, quietly, almost stubbornly, to teams who should know better by now. Against England in the T20 World Cup semifinal, it slipped once more from the noose and into another global final, chasing down 166 with five wickets in hand and an over to spare.

For long stretches, the chase felt like it was drifting away. The pitch was slow, England's bowlers disciplined, and with 57 needed off the last four overs, the moment seemed to belong elsewhere. Then Daryl Mitchell, previously scratchy and uncertain, found his timing and his nerve. Jimmy Neesham arrived like a thunderclap, dismantling Chris Jordan for 19 in a single over that cost 23, and suddenly the game tilted.

Neesham fell, but Mitchell did not. He took charge, launching Adil Rashid and then brutalising Chris Woakes for 19 in an over that broke England's resistance. His unbeaten 72 carried New Zealand home.